



JERUSALEM INTERNATIONAL FELLOWS

Dear <<First Name>>,

I hope you and yours are well as fall arrives, the "school year" has begun, and a New Year approaches.

The evaluators of the **2022 Jerusalem International Fellows** concluded that: *As a pilot launched in less than optimal time constraints, the program had a resounding impact already, and with a few tweaks and improvements, can easily become a permanent fixture in the Jerusalem community, with host organizations lined up to take part.*

I want to take a moment to appreciate all the people who made this residency possible. I'll start with the JIF [Board of Advisors](#) - all of whom have stayed with this program through thick and thin, encouraged me to continue over the years, and have given enormous time, wisdom, and financial support.

Abundant thanks to our early and ongoing supporters Roselyn Swig, Bloomberg Philanthropies, and The Russell Berrie Foundation. Their initial

investments encouraged others to join our effort. In 2019, Malcolm Thomson, Bonnie Roche, and other friends and colleagues stepped up. Lynn Schneider contributed funds to meet a timely Challenge in 2020 and later became the first Sponsor of a Fellow: Vibha Galhotra.

Supporters continued to take a chance, in spite of the uncertain timeline caused by the pandemic. Former Fellows David Karnovsky and Josh Sirefman each sponsored one of the weekly Salons. Anita Abramowitz, Naomi Caspe, Agnes Gund, the Jerusalem Foundation, the Leichtag Foundation, the Schusterman Foundation, and so many individuals believed in our mission to bring extraordinary International artists to engage with Jerusalem's creative eco-system - East and West. You can see the full list of our generous donors [here](#).

Our fantastic Host Organization leaders: Melhem Bader at [Ibdaa School for the Arts](#), Matan Israeli at [Muslala](#), Maya Halevi at [Bloomfield Science Museum](#), Elad Schechter at [Catamon Dance Group](#) and their amazing teams went above and beyond to realize this Program. And it would not have been successful without an amazing team in Jerusalem - Elana Ben Haim and Nermeen Schweiki. Finally, the greatest mark of success - the extraordinary Jerusalemites from all over the city who offered our Fellows guidance, hospitality, and friendship. It really does take a village.

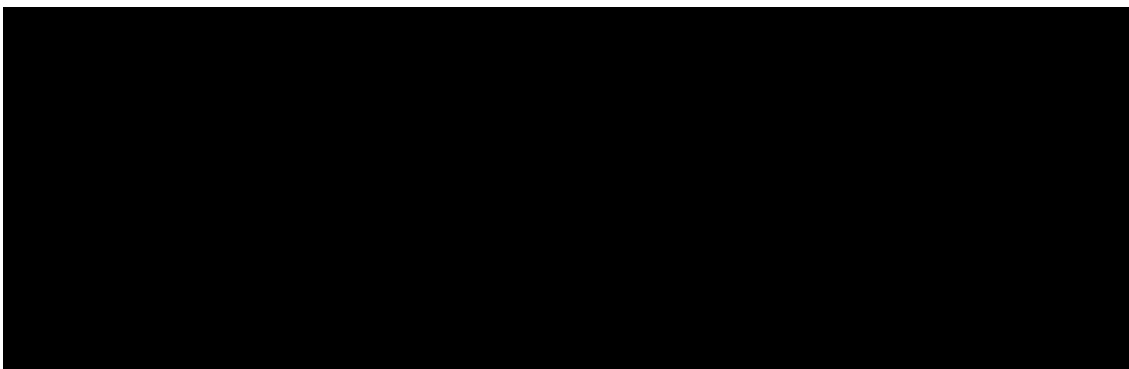
I hope all of you take pride in the incredible experiences you provided to our Fellows and the hundreds of people who engaged with them in their creative projects.

[email me](#)

Whatever your faith, we wish you a happy, prosperous and PEACEFUL year.



"The ten-weeks were filled with meaningful introductions, experiences, and creative collaborations. The nucleus was just four artists, each matched with a host organization. Together, they inspired many people in various disciplines across west and east Jerusalem."



"The overwhelming number of significant relationships that were created by the artists, beyond those they made within their host organizations, far surpassed expectations."

From the artists:

"Overall, I made real friendships and got to understand Jerusalem on a very, very deep level-- which I think was the point. And was definitely achieved. This was an amazing life changing experience in many ways. I developed strong relations with people, and I will only begin to understand it once I've had time to digest it all."

"Every residency has it's specificity. Here the orientation included engaging tours to understand some of the layers and complexities that make Jerusalem unique. I have never experienced such a strong religious culture experience. We delved into all the political, economic, and social layers in Israel, leaving room for us to pick and choose. Other residencies have the host organization explain the local scene from their own perspective. The Jerusalem Fellowship gives me more clarity. Here I think of politics as differences, which is a big change in my work."

"They prepared us well... Then we were free to explore... like the 7 gates of the Old City. It was up to us to decide which doors we wished to enter and when...Jerusalem is a labyrinth. You need to be strong and find your way...I opened a window and found a garden. Now it will grow."

"There was a shared sense of something important taking place...What we started at Ibdaa needs to continue for the sake of humanity. It was really something special that has great potential to change perspectives and enrich the children's lives through art."

You can read the full evaluation by On Track Consulting [here](#).



We will continue to upload photos, videos, and reflections from our Fellows. You can also enjoy photos and videos on our Instagram [@jerusaleminternationalfellows](https://www.instagram.com/jerusaleminternationalfellows).

All of the press we have received can be found [here](#).

We welcome your questions and comments and look forward to telling and showing you more about our Fellows as their connections unfold.

We hope to see you on zoom on . Please [email me](#) if
you'd like the link.

Thanks to all of you who have helped realize this program, which will continue to bear fruit
as we start planning for the next residency in Fall 2024. Stay tuned....

Enjoy the Fall!

Elise

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